STEFAN J. DIETRICH

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Economics Ph.D. candidate (Boston University, May 2027) specializing in causal inference on large, messy datasets — panel, geospatial, and archival. Five years turning raw records into research-grade data and credible estimates. Available from mid-2027.

EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher, Boston University, Department of Economics 2021 – present

- Estimated the causal effect of professional societies on innovation in 19th-century Germany with staggered difference-in-differences (Callaway–Sant'Anna) on a corpus of high-value patents, 1877–1918: chapter founding raises local patenting by c. 4%, driven by practicing owner-engineers (job market paper).
- Priced the ecosystem services of U.S. peatlands at the parcel level from 30 m national raster data (USDA Forest Service, land values, flood mitigation) and built the national conservation supply curve: 79% of peatland conservable at or below \$50/tCO_2, securing 28.6 MtCO_2/yr for \$14.0B present value (co-authored working paper).
- Designed an instrumental-variables strategy based on climate suitability for viticulture (Huglin index) to explain the location of Germany's export-champion manufacturing firms; viticulture raises a municipality's count of such firms by 31% (working paper).
- Taught 12+ undergraduate and master's sections in micro-, macroeconomics, and economic history; mean student evaluation 4.2/5.

Research Assistant, University of Mannheim, Department of Economics 2019 – 2020

- Cleaned and digitized historical records and built research-ready datasets for empirical work on long-run economic growth.
- Ran econometric analyses, including spatial regressions with Conley HAC standard errors, and coordinated a team of research assistants.

Farm Manager, Family-owned crop–livestock farm (250 acres), Germany 2011 – 2012

- Ran the farm at age 18: negotiated sales contracts to hedge price risk; recruited and managed seasonal workers.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Boston University — expected May 2027

M.Sc. in Economics, London School of Economics — 2019

B.Sc. in Economics, University of Mannheim (top 1% of cohort) — 2018

SKILLS

Programming & tools: Stata (advanced), Python, R, SQL, QGIS, Git, Excel, LaTeX
Methods: causal inference (difference-in-differences, IV, event studies), panel econometrics, geospatial analysis, cost–benefit and present-value analysis, large-scale data digitization and OCR pipelines
Languages: German (native), English (fluent)

AWARDS

Scholarship, German National Academic Foundation (top 0.5% of German students), 2016 – 2019
Best Second-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, Boston University, 2023

German citizen; F-1 visa with post-graduation OPT work authorization.